

West Coast Research Symposium on Technology Entrepreneurship

SEPTEMBER 11 AND 12, 2025



FOSTER
SCHOOL OF BUSINESS
SEATTLE, WA



**UNIVERSITY
OF ALBERTA**

UC SANTA BARBARA
UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA



**UNIVERSITY OF
OREGON**



USC University of
Southern California



**UNIVERSITY of
WASHINGTON**

WCRS 2025

DAY 1: Thursday, September 11 | Founders Hall

8:00–8:30 AM | Welcome and Breakfast | Founders Hall 170

8:30–8:40 AM | Greeting from Foster Dean Frank Hodge

8:40–9:45 AM | Socio-Cultural Entrepreneurship: Identity, Narratives, and Meaning-Making in Institutional Environments

Dominant Deceptions: How Entrepreneurial Narratives Tip into Deception

Aharon Cohen Mohliver, London Business School; Tiona Zuzul, Harvard Business School

Don't Forget Who You Are: How the Conflict Between Social and Organizational Institutional Logics Influences the Crowdfunding Success of Open-Source Projects

Zhuoxuan Li, Stanford University; Robert Eberhart, University of San Diego; Charles Eesley, Stanford University; Andreea Gorbatai, Vlerick University

Being Heard: The Gendered Reception and Construction of Entrepreneurial Failure Narratives

Jessica Santana, UC Santa Barbara; Jennifer Jennings, Dev Jennings, University of Alberta

Cognitive Embeddedness and Cultural Entrepreneurship: The Role of Media Narratives in Shaping Entrepreneurial Possibilities

Jeremy Lei Xu, University of Missouri-St. Louis; Jade Lo, Drexel University; Eric Yanfei Zhao, University of Oxford

10:15–11:15 AM | Regional Economies, Place-Based Resources and Entrepreneurship

People or Place? Founder Intentions, Entrepreneurial Regions, and Technology Startups

Michael Roach, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign; Min Jung Kim, Korea University

One Size Does Not Fit All: An Analysis of Agglomeration-Firm Fit on New Manufacturing Firm Performance

Lauren Lanahan, University of Oregon; Nikhil Kalathil, Carnegie Mellon University

Venturing in Limbo: Entrepreneurial Resourcefulness by the Forcibly Displaced

Sadek Showkat, Loyola University Chicago; Oana Branzei, Ivey Business School; Alan Meyer, University of Oregon

11:30–12:30 PM | Job Market Candidates: Introductions

12:30–1:45 PM | Lunch | Founders Hall 180

2:00–3:15 PM | Entrepreneurship in Nascent Industries: Paths to Viability | Founders Hall 170

Successful Failures: Category Infrastructure and Cumulative Advantage in the Modern Rebirth of the Electric Vehicle (1990–2014)

Hovig Tchalian, University of Southern California; Vern Glaser, University of Alberta; Mark Kennedy, Imperial College

Catching the Wave or Wiping Out? The Rise and Fall (and Rise) of Ocean Energy in the United Kingdom

Liz Hood, Tiffany Yau, University of Southern California; Jeff York, University of Colorado Boulder; Jake Grandy, University of Arkansas; Shon Hiatt, University of Southern California

When Sustainability Labels Backfire: A Randomized Field Experiment with Equity Investors

Anna Lukkarinen, Simon Fraser University; Riitta Katila, Stanford University

Justifying the Means: Institutional Evaluator Reassessments of Sustainability Products Pitched with AI

Bandita Deka Kalita, Oklahoma State University; Maggie Cascadden, University of Alberta

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DAY 1 *Continued*: Thursday, September 11 | Founders Hall

3:45–5:15 PM | Unintended Consequences of Policy and Practice for Innovation and Inequality | Founders Hall 170

Data Privacy Regulation and Innovation: The Role of Costs and Trust in Collaborative R&D

Sukhun Kang, UC Santa Barbara; Jennifer Kao, UCLA

Do Biomedical Researchers Study Topics Related to Their Own Ethnicity?: Evidence From the NIH

Wesley H. Greenblatt, Harvard University; Young Hou, University of Virginia; Sukhun Kang, UC Santa Barbara

Evaluation-in-the-Wild: Explaining the Processes and Consequences of Evaluation Drift

Sara Mahabadi, University of Alberta; Arvind Karunakaran, Stanford University; Lisa Cohen, McGill University

Founders' Pre-Entry Knowledge and Experience and the Benefits of Startup Accelerators

Melody Chang, University of Southern California; Valentina Assenova, University of Pennsylvania

Curating Inequality? Platform Intermediation and Gender Gaps in Music Streaming

Joanna Li, University of Alberta; Tomasz Obloj, Indiana University

5:15-8:00 PM | Dinner | Peek Forum, Founders Hall 580

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DAY 2: Friday, September 12 | Founders Hall

8:30–9:00 AM | Breakfast | Founders Hall 170

9:00–10:00 AM | Innovation, Knowledge Foundations and Entrepreneurial Intermediaries

Bringing Science to Market: Knowledge Foundations, Inventor-Founders, and Performance

Justine Boudou, Harvard Business School; Maria Roche, Harvard Business School

Skilled Intermediaries in Innovation: Occupational Expertise and the Flow of Knowledge between Technology-based Ventures

Danielle Bovenberg, University of Colorado Boulder

Honor Among Thieves: Vulnerable Network Positions, Norms of Reciprocity, and IPO Rates in the Biotechnology Sector

Andrew Foley, New York University

10:30–11:45 AM | Navigating the Future: With Theory and a Little Help from Thought-Partners?

Theory-driven AI Use in Strategic Decision-Making: Experimental Evidence From Strategy Simulations

Ryan Allen, Brigham Young University; Mana Heshmati, University of Washington; Rory McDonald, Michael Lenox, Maelle Perez, University of Virginia

Is Using Data Analytics Helpful for New Ventures in Gaining Greater Traction? If So, When Are They More Effective?

Sung Park, University of Oregon

Moderate Obsession from Entrepreneurial Vision: How stronger visions of the future lead to value-based strategic decision-making in the present

Timothy Ott, UNC-Chapel Hill; Douglas Hannah, Boston University

12:00–1:00 PM | Lunch | Founders Hall 170

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Authors in Attendance

Ryan Allen
Brigham Young University

Danielle Bovenberg
University of Colorado Boulder

Maggie Cascadden
University of Alberta

Melody Chang
University of Southern California

Bandita Deka Kalita
Oklahoma State University

Robert Eberhart
University of San Diego

Charles Eesley
Stanford University

Andrew Foley
New York University

Vern Glaser
University of Alberta

Jake Grandy
University of Arkansas

Wesley Greenblatt
Harvard University

Mana Heshmati
University of Washington

Nikhil Kalathil
Carnegie Mellon University

Sukhun Kang
UC Santa Barbara

Arvind Karunakaran
Stanford University

Riitta Katila
Stanford University

Mark Kennedy
Imperial College

Lauren Lanahan
University of Oregon

Joanna Li
University of Alberta

Zhuoxuan Li
Hong Kong University

Jade Lo
Drexel University

Anna Lukkarinen
Simon Fraser University

Sara Mahabadi
University of Alberta

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Harvard Business School

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Hovig Tchalian
University of Southern California

Jeremy Lei Xu
University of Missouri-St. Louis

Tiffany Yau
University of Southern California

Jeff York
University of Colorado Boulder

Tiona Zuzul
Harvard Business School

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About the Buerk Center for Entrepreneurship

Foster School of Business, University of Washington

Founded in 1991, the Buerk Center offers an exceptional curriculum, real-world experiences, and connections to the Seattle entrepreneurial community to inspire students from all majors and disciplines across campus to pursue their entrepreneurial passions.

While our core curriculum focuses on entrepreneurial strategy, finance, and marketing, our electives run the gamut from Venture Investing to Software Entrepreneurship, from Grand Challenges for Entrepreneurs to Biomedical Entrepreneurship. The Buerk Center focuses on the strengths of the University of Washington and Seattle, and creates new courses that capitalize on those strengths.

Seattle is also a magnet for entrepreneurs. It has an entrepreneurial culture, research powerhouses, support for early-stage entrepreneurs, sources of capital, a talented pool of workers, and a strong media to tell startup stories.